

More wind beneath Air India's wings

Air India (AI) is **ramping up** its **codeshare arrangements** to expand its network coverage and **feed** its international trunk routes. Since its **acquisition** by Tata Group nearly two years ago, it has signed 19 codeshare agreements. It now plans to **establish** 10 additional codeshare partnerships this financial year. **Outbound** travel from India is one of the fastest-growing components of global **aviation**. The codeshare strategy helps AI **claw back** market share from Gulf carriers, which had enjoyed a free run with India-origin traffic. This segment offers some of the highest **margins** for Indian airlines and helps **shore up** profitability on domestic routes, where IndiGo leads. AI is upgrading its **ageing fleet**, and codesharing **comes in handy** while it **awaits** aircraft deliveries.

IndiGo is not as aggressive about international **alliances**, which favour full-service carriers. The budget airline's **dominance** at home **allows** for a more relaxed approach to international travel. Yet, it has its own **clutch** of codeshare agreements, and may have to sign more as it, too, awaits delivery of **long-haul** aircraft. IndiGo will also have to **adapt** to changing preferences of Indian flyers, who are increasingly valuing service over price on domestic routes. This shift should support its international play by enabling integrated offerings across segments. While AI is currently taking the fight to West Asian airlines, IndiGo will have to **join the party** at some point.



Indian airlines have **capitalised on** the economy's **rapid** recovery from Covid **disruptions** to accelerate aircraft capacity addition. This **nimbleness** has helped **offset** some of the fuel cost advantages enjoyed by Gulf carriers. Bigger gains are possible if Indian airlines expand their presence in these segments. But fleet size isn't the only **constraint**. Indian **aviation** still needs to **catch up** in areas such as **manpower** and maintenance. For its part, AI must **address legacy** issues **stemming from** its years as a PSU. Innovative **strategies** like codesharing **offer** Indian carriers **accelerated** pathways to profitability.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

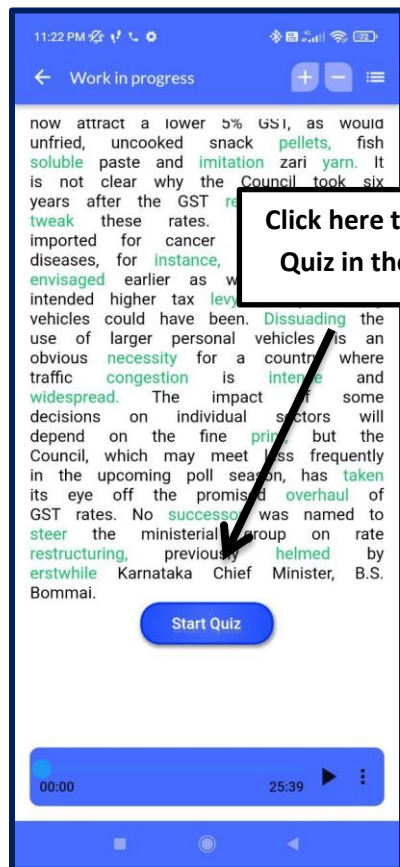
1. **Wind beneath someone's wings** (phrase) – support, encouragement, motivation, empowerment, boost समर्थन या प्रेरणा देना
2. **Ramp up** (phrasal verb) – increase, boost, enhance, escalate, intensify बढ़ाना
3. **Codeshare arrangement** (noun) – a partnership between airlines where one airline markets and sells seats on a flight operated by another airline साझेदारी व्यवस्था (विमानन क्षेत्र में)
4. **Feed** (verb) – supply, support, provide, nourish, fuel आपूर्ति करना / मदद करना
5. **Acquisition** (noun) – purchase, takeover, procurement, buyout, merger अधिग्रहण
6. **Establish** (verb) – set up, initiate, create, form, launch स्थापित करना
7. **Outbound** (adjective) – departing, outgoing, overseas, leaving, external बाहर जाने वाला
8. **Aviation** (noun) – air travel, aeronautics, flight, aerospace, airline industry विमानन
9. **Claw back** (phrasal verb) – regain, recover, retrieve, recapture, reclaim वापस पाना / पुनः प्राप्त करना
10. **Margin** (noun) – profit, difference, spread, buffer, surplus लाभान्श
11. **Shore up** (phrasal verb) – strengthen, reinforce, support, back, stabilize समर्थन करना
12. **Ageing** (adjective) – old, outdated, worn-out, aging, obsolete पुराना
13. **Fleet** (noun) – a group of ships sailing together, engaged in the same activity, or under the same ownership. बेड़ा
14. **Come in handy** (phrase) – prove useful, help, assist, be beneficial, be convenient काम आना
15. **Await** (verb) – wait for, anticipate, expect, be ready for, look forward to प्रतीक्षा करना
16. **Alliance** (noun) – partnership, union, coalition, association, collaboration गठबंधन
17. **Dominance** (noun) – control, supremacy, leadership, influence, authority प्रमुखता
18. **Clutch** (noun) – group, batch, bunch, set, collection समूह
19. **Long-haul** (adjective) – long-distance, far-reaching, extended, intercontinental, transoceanic – लंबी दूरी की (यात्रा)
20. **Adapt** (verb) – adjust, modify, accommodate, conform, tailor अनुकूलन करना

21. **Join the party** (phrase) – participate, get involved, enter the field, catch up, join the trend शामिल होना / प्रतिस्पर्धा में आना
22. **Capitalise** (on) (verb) – take advantage of, exploit, benefit from, leverage, utilise लाभ उठाना
23. **Rapid** (adjective) – fast, swift, quick, accelerated, brisk तीव्र
24. **Disruption** (noun) – interruption, disturbance, breakdown, disorder, upheaval विघटन / बाधा
25. **Nimbleness** (noun) – agility, flexibility, quickness, responsiveness, adaptability चुस्ती / फुर्ती
26. **Offset** (verb) – counterbalance, neutralize, compensate, balance out, cancel संतुलित करना
27. **Constraint** (noun) – limitation, restriction, hindrance, curb, barrier प्रतिबंध / अड़चन
28. **Aviation** (noun) – aeronautics, flying, air travel, aircraft industry, flight operations विमानन
29. **Catch up** (phrasal verb) – reach the same level, keep pace, match, make up for, bridge the gap बराबरी पर आना
30. **Manpower** (noun) – workforce, personnel, human resources, staff, labor जनशक्ति
31. **Address** (verb) – tackle, deal with, handle, respond to, focus on समाधान करना
32. **Legacy** (noun) – inheritance, heritage, leftover, past issue, carryover विरासत
33. **Stem from** (phrasal verb) – originate from, arise from, result from, derive from, emerge from से उत्पन्न होना
34. **Accelerated** (adjective) – fast-tracked, hastened, quickened, rapid, expedited तीव्र / तेज़ किया हुआ

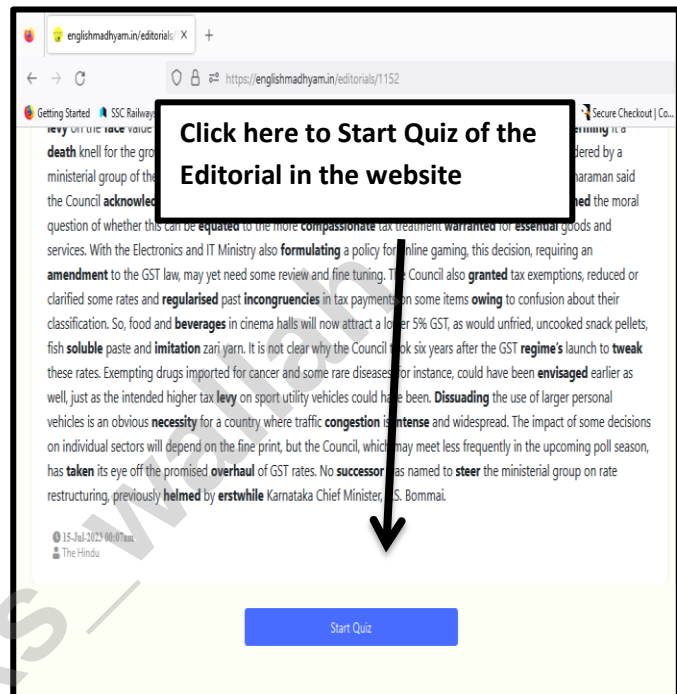
Summary of the Editorial

1. Air India (AI) is expanding its global network through increased codeshare agreements.
2. Since Tata Group's takeover nearly two years ago, AI has signed 19 codeshare deals.
3. It plans to add 10 more codeshare partnerships in the current financial year.
4. Outbound travel from India is growing rapidly, making it a lucrative aviation market.
5. The codeshare strategy helps AI regain market share from Gulf carriers dominating India-origin traffic.
6. These international routes offer higher profit margins than domestic ones.
7. AI is also upgrading its ageing fleet, and codesharing fills gaps while awaiting new aircraft deliveries.
8. IndiGo, India's largest domestic airline, has been slower to form international alliances.
9. IndiGo's domestic dominance allows it to be more cautious with international expansion.
10. However, it has some codeshare deals and may need more as it plans long-haul operations.
11. Indian travellers increasingly prefer better service over lower fares, even on domestic routes.
12. This trend may benefit full-service carriers like AI and force IndiGo to enhance its offerings.
13. Indian airlines are growing fast, aided by the economy's recovery post-Covid.
14. Rapid fleet expansion has helped Indian carriers counter Gulf airlines' fuel cost advantages.
15. However, challenges remain, including workforce and maintenance capacity; AI must also overcome its public-sector legacy to stay competitive.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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